

Bhagavad Gita - Chapter 1

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

001. Chapter 1 Summary

VERSE 1.1

धृतराष्ट्र उवाच ।
धर्मक्षेत्रे कुरुक्षेत्रे समवेता युयुत्सवः ।
मामकाः पाण्डवाश्चैव किमकुर्वत सञ्जय ॥१॥

dhṛtarāṣṭra uvāca |
dharma-kṣetre kuru-kṣetre
samavetā yuyutsavaḥ |
māmakāḥ pāṇḍavāś caiva
kim akurvata sañjaya || 1 ||

◆ dhṛtarāṣṭraḥ uvāca – Dhritarashtra said; ◆ dharma-kṣetre – on the field of Dharma; kuru-kṣetre – on the field of the Kurus; ◆ samavetāḥ – gathered together; yuyutsavaḥ – desiring to fight; ◆ māmakāḥ – my people (sons); pāṇḍavāḥ – the sons of Pandu; ca – and; eva – also; ◆ kim – what; akurvata – did they do; sañjaya – O Sanjaya.

Dhritarashtra said: Having assembled on the holy plain in Kurukshetra desirous of fighting the battle, what did my people and the Pandavas do? O Sanjaya!

VERSE 1.2

सञ्जय उवाच ।

दृष्ट्वा तु पाण्डवानीकं व्यूढं दुर्योधनस्तदा ।

आचार्यमुपसङ्गम्य राजा वचनमब्रवीत् ॥ २ ॥

sañjaya uvāca |

dr̥ṣṭvā tu pāṇḍavānīkaṃ

vyūḍhaṃ duryodhanas tadā |

ācāryam upasaṅgamyā

rājā vacanam abravīt || 2 ||

◆ sañjayaḥ uvāca – Sanjaya said; ◆ dr̥ṣṭvā – having seen; tu – but; pāṇḍava-anīkaṃ – the army of the Pandavas; ◆ vyūḍhaṃ – in military formation; duryodhanaḥ – King Duryodhana; tadā – then; ◆ ācāryam – the teacher (Drona); upasaṅgamyā – having approached; ◆ rājā – the King; vacanam – words; abravīt – spoke.

Sanjaya said: On seeing the Pāṇḍava army arrayed for battle, King Duryodhana went to his teacher and spoke these words:

VERSE 1.3

पश्यैतां पाण्डुपुत्राणामाचार्य महतीं चमूम् ।
व्यूढां द्रुपदपुत्रेण तव शिष्येण धीमता ॥ ३ ॥

paśyaitāṃ pāṇḍu-putrāṇām
ācārya mahatīm camūm |
vyūḍhām drupada-putreṇa
tava śiṣyeṇa dhīmatā || 3 ||

◆ paśya – behold; eitām – this; pāṇḍu-putrāṇām – of the sons of Pandu; ◆
ācārya – O Teacher; mahatīm – mighty; camūm – army; ◆ vyūḍhām – arranged
in formation; drupada-putreṇa – by the son of Drupada (Dhrishtadyumna); ◆
tava – your; śiṣyeṇa – by the disciple; dhīmatā – talented/wise.

**O teacher, behold the great army of the sons of Pāṇdu
arrayed by your talented disciple, the son of Drupada.**

VERSE 1.4-6

अत्र शूरा महेष्वासा भीमार्जुनसमा युधि ।
युयुधानो विराटश्च द्रुपदश्च महारथः ॥ ४ ॥

atra śūrā maheṣvāsā
bhīmārjuna-samā yudhi |
yuyudhāno virāṭaś ca
drupadaś ca mahārathaḥ || 4 ||

◆ atra – here; śūrāḥ – heroes; mahā-iṣv-āsāḥ – mighty archers; ◆ bhīma-arjuna-samāḥ – equal to Bhima and Arjuna; yudhi – in battle; ◆ yuyudhānaḥ – Yuyudhana; virāṭaḥ – Virata; ca – and; ◆ drupadaḥ – Drupada; ca – and; mahārathaḥ – a great chariot-warrior.

In that army are mighty archers and heroes, in battle equal to Bhima and Arjuna: Yuyudhāna, Virāta, and Drupada, each a mahāratha; Heroic Dhrishtaketu, Chekitāna, and the king of Kāśi; Purujit, Kuntibhoja, and Śaivya, all the best of men; Powerful Yudhāmanyu, brave Uttamaújā, Subhadrā's son, and the sons of Draupadi - all mahārathas indeed.

VERSE 1.7

अस्माकं तु विशिष्टा ये तान्निबोध द्विजोत्तम ।
नायका मम सैन्यस्य संज्ञार्थं तान्ब्रवीमि ते ॥ ७ ॥

asmākaṃ tu viśiṣṭā ye
tān nibodha dvijottama |
nāyakā mama sainyasya
saṃjñārthaṃ tān bravāmi te || 7 ||

◆ asmākaṃ – ours; tu – but/on the other hand; viśiṣṭāḥ – the distinguished; ye – who; ◆ tān – them; nibodha – know/be informed; dvija-uttama – O best of the twice-born (Drona); ◆ nāyakāḥ – the leaders; mama – my; sainyasya – of the army; ◆ saṃjñā-artham – for the sake of information; tān – them; bravāmi – I speak; te – to you.

(Having named some of the foremost heroes of the Pandava Army, Duryodhana mentions the names of warriors on his side) O best of the twice-born, let me also recount to you the leaders of my own army, those distinguished amongst ourselves. I shall name them, that you may know them all:

VERSE 1.8-9

भवान्भीष्मश्च कर्णश्च कृपश्च समितिञ्जयः ।
अश्वत्थामा विकर्णश्च सौमदत्तिस्तथैव च ॥ ८ ॥

bhavān bhīṣmaś ca karṇaś ca
kṛpaś ca samitiñjayaḥ |
aśvatthāmā vikarṇaś ca
saumadattis tathaiva ca || 8 ||

◆ bhavān – yourself (Drona); bhīṣmaḥ – Bhishma; ca – and; karṇaḥ – Karna; ca – and; ◆ kṛpaḥ – Kripa; ca – and; samitim-jayaḥ – victorious in battle; ◆ aśvatthāmā – Ashwatthama; vikarṇaḥ – Vikarna; ca – and; ◆ saumadattiḥ – the son of Somadatta; tathā eva ca – and also certainly.

**Yourself and Bhishma and Karna; Kripa, who is ever
victorious in war; Aśvatthāmā, Vikarna, Jayadratha, and
Somadatta's son; And many other heroes besides, armed
with many weapons, each well skilled in battle, and all
resolved to lay down their lives to serve my cause.**

VERSE 1.10

अपर्याप्तं तदस्माकं बलं भीष्माभिरक्षितम् ।
पर्याप्तं त्विदमेतेषां बलं भीमाभिरक्षितम् ॥ १० ॥

aparyāptam tad asmākaṃ
balaṃ bhīṣmābhirakṣitam |
paryāptam tv idam eteṣāṃ
balaṃ bhīmaabhirakṣitam || 10 ||

◆ aparyāptam – immeasurable/unlimited; tat – that; asmākaṃ – ours; ◆ balaṃ – strength/army; bhīṣma-abhirakṣitam – marshalled by Bhishma; ◆ paryāptam – limited/measurable; tu – but; idam – this; eteṣāṃ – of theirs; ◆ balaṃ – strength/army; bhīma-abhirakṣitam – marshalled by Bhima.

(Having named the various warriors on both sides Duryodhana now declares that his own army is superior.) But this army of ours, protected by Bhishma, is unlimited, and that army of theirs, protected by Bhima, is limited.

VERSE 1.11

अयनेषु च सर्वेषु यथाभागमवस्थिताः ।
भीष्ममेवाभिरक्षन्तु भवन्तः सर्व एव हि ॥ ११ ॥

ayaneṣu ca sarveṣu
yathā-bhāgam avasthitāḥ |
bhīṣmam evābhirakṣantu
bhavantaḥ sarva eva hi || 11 ||

◆ ayaneṣu – in the strategic points; ca – and; sarveṣu – in all; ◆ yathā-bhāgam – in your respective positions; avasthitāḥ – stationed; ◆ bhīṣmam – Bhishma; eva – alone; abhirakṣantu – should protect; ◆ bhavantaḥ – you; sarve – all; eva hi – certainly.

Now take your proper places in front of your marshalled troops and protect Bhishma alone.

VERSE 1.12

तस्य सञ्जनयन् हर्षं कुरुवृद्धः पितामहः ।
सिंहनादं विनद्योच्चैः शङ्खं दध्मौ प्रतापवान् ॥ १२ ॥

tasya sañjanayan harṣam
kuru-vṛddhaḥ pitāmahaḥ |
siṃha-nādam vinadyoccaiḥ
śaṅkham dadhmau pratāpavān || 12 ||

◆ tasya – his (Duryodhana’s); sañjanayan – causing; harṣam – joy; ◆ kuru-vṛddhaḥ – the aged of the Kuru clan; pitāmahaḥ – the grandfather (Bhishma); ◆ siṃha-nādam – a lion’s roar; vinadya – sounding; uccaiḥ – loudly; ◆ śaṅkham – conch shell; dadhmau – blew; pratāpavān – the glorious.

**Bhishma the grandsire, the glorious, the oldest of the Kurus,
gave forth a lion-roar and blew his conch, causing joy to
Duryodhana.**

VERSE 1.13

ततः शङ्खाश्च भेर्यश्च पणवानकगोमुखाः ।
सहसैवाभ्यहन्यन्त स शब्दस्तुमुलोऽभवत् ॥१३ ॥

tataḥ śaṅkhāś ca bheryaś ca
paṇavānaka-gomukhāḥ |
sahasāivābhyahanyanta
sa śabdastumulo'bhavat || 13 ||

◆ **tataḥ**—then; **śaṅkhāḥ**—conch shells; **ca**—and; **bheryaḥ**—kettledrums; **ca**—and; ◆ **paṇava-ānaka**—tabors and drums; **go-mukhāḥ**—horns; ◆ **sahasā**—suddenly; **eva**—certainly; **abhyahanyanta**—blared forth; ◆ **saḥ**—that; **śabdaḥ**—sound; **tumulaḥ**—tumultuous; **abhavat**—was.

(Following the example of Bhishma, other heroes blew the conches, and drums, trumpets, and horns were sounded.)
Then conchs and kettle-drums, tabors and trumpets and cow-horns suddenly blared forth; and the sound was stupendous.

VERSE 1.14

ततः श्वेतैर्हयैर्युक्ते महति स्यन्दने स्थितौ ।
माधवः पाण्डवश्चैव दिव्यौ शङ्खौ प्रदध्मतुः ॥ १४ ॥

tataḥ śvetair hayairyukte
mahati syandane sthitau |
mādhavaḥ pāṇḍavaś caiva
divyau śaṅkhau pradadhmatuḥ || 14 ||

◆ **tataḥ**—then; **śvetaiḥ**—with white; **hayaiḥ**—horses; **yukte**—yoked; ◆ **mahati**—in a magnificent; **syandane**—chariot; **sthitau**—seated; ◆ **mādhavaḥ**—Krishna; **pāṇḍavaḥ**—Arjuna; **ca**—and; **eva**—also; ◆ **divyau**—divine; **śaṅkhau**—conch shells; **pradadhmatuḥ**—blew.

**Whereupon Mādhava and Pāṇḍava, seated in their
magnificent chariot yoked to white horses, also blew their
celestial conchs.**

पाञ्चजन्यं हृषीकेशो देवदत्तं धनञ्जयः ।
पौण्ड्रं दध्मौ महाशङ्खं भीमकर्मा वृकोदरः ॥ १५ ॥

pāñcajanyaṃ hr̥ṣīkeśo
devadattaṃ dhanañjayaḥ |
pauṇḍraṃ dadhmau mahā-śaṅkhaṃ
bhīma-karmā vṛkodaraḥ || 15 ||

◆ **pāñcajanya**—the conch named Panchajanya; **hr̥ṣīkeśaḥ**—Krishna; ◆
devadatta—the conch named Devadatta; **dhanañjayaḥ**—Arjuna; ◆
pauṇḍra—the conch named Paundra; **dadhmau**—blew; **mahā-śaṅkha**—
mighty conch; ◆ **bhīma-karmā**—doer of terrible deeds; **vṛkodaraḥ**—Bhima.

Hrishikeśa blew His conch, the Pāñchajanya; Dhananjaya, the Devadatta; and Vrikodara, the doer of fearful deeds, blew his great conch, the Paundra. King Yudhishtira, the son of Kunti, blew his conch, the Anantavijaya; and Nakula and Sahadeva blew the Sughosha and the Manipushpaka. The great archer, the king of Kāśī; the great warrior Śikhandi; Dhristadyumna and Virāta; the unconquered Sātyaki; Drupada, and the sons of Draupadi, and the mighty son of Subhadrā, O Lord of the Earth, each blew his own conch.

VERSE 1.19

स घोषो धार्तराष्ट्राणां हृदयानि व्यदारयत् ।
नभश्च पृथिवीं चैव तुमुलो व्यनुनादयन् ॥१९॥

sa ghoṣo dhārtarāṣṭrāṇām
hṛdayāni vyadārayat |
nabhaś ca pṛthivīm caiva
tumulo vyanunādayan || 19 ||

◆ saḥ – that; ghoṣaḥ – uproar; dhārtarāṣṭrāṇām – of the sons of Dhritarashtra;
◆ hṛdayāni – hearts; vyadārayat – rent/shattered; ◆ nabhaḥ – the sky; ca – and;
pṛthivīm – the earth; ca – and; eva – also; ◆ tumulaḥ – tumultuous;
vyanunādayan – vibrating/resounding.

**And that tumult, resounding through heaven and earth, rent
the hearts of Dhritarāshtra's followers.**

VERSE 1.20

अथ व्यवस्थितान्दृष्ट्वा धार्तराष्ट्रान् कपिध्वजः ।
प्रवृत्ते शस्त्रसम्पाते धनुरुद्यम्य पाण्डवः ॥ २० ॥

atha vyavasthitān dṛṣṭvā
dhārtarāṣṭrān kapi-dhvajaḥ |
pravṛtte śastra-sampāte
dhanur udyamya pāṇḍavaḥ || 20 ||

◆ atha – then; vyavasthitān – standing in battle formation; dṛṣṭvā – seeing; ◆
dhārtarāṣṭrān – the sons of Dhritarashtra; kapi-dhvajaḥ – he whose flag is
marked with Hanuman (Arjuna); ◆ pravṛtte – about to begin; śastra-sampāte –
the discharge of weapons; ◆ dhanuḥ – bow; udyamya – taking up; pāṇḍavaḥ –
the son of Pandu (Arjuna).

**O King! Now seeing the Kauravas arrayed in battle order and
the discharge of weapons about to begin, Arjuna took up his
bow and spoke these words to Lord Krishna.**

हृषीकेशं तदा वाक्यमिदमाह महीपते ।

अर्जुन उवाच । सेनयोरुभयोर्मध्ये रथं स्थापय मेऽच्युत ॥ २१ ॥

यावदेतान्निरीक्षेऽहं योद्धुकामानवस्थितान् ।

कैर्मया सह योद्धव्यमस्मिन् रणसमुद्यमे ॥ २२ ॥

hr̥ṣīkeśaṃ tadā vākyaṃ idam āha mahī-pate | arjuna uvāca | senayor ubhayor
madhye rathaṃ sthāpaya me'cyuta || 21 ||

Arjuna said: O Achyuta, between the two armies draw up my chariot, that I may behold those who stand there eager to fight, and may know, on the eve of battle, with whom I must contend.

VERSE 1.23

योत्स्यमानानवेक्षेऽहं य एतेऽत्र समागताः ।
धार्तराष्ट्रस्य दुर्बुद्धेर्युद्धे प्रियचिकीर्षवः ॥ २३ ॥

yotsyamānān avekṣe'ham
ya ete'tra samāgatāḥ |
dhārtarāṣṭrasya durbuddher
yuddhe priya-cikīrṣavaḥ || 23 ||

◆ yotsyamānān – those who are going to fight; avekṣe – may behold; aham – I; ◆
ye – who; ete – these; atra – here; samāgatāḥ – gathered; ◆ dhārtarāṣṭrasya – of
the son of Dhritarashtra (Duryodhana); durbuddheḥ – evil-minded; ◆ yuddhe –
in the fight; priya-cikīrṣavaḥ – wishing to please.

**I would observe these warriors assembled here for the battle
wishing to please the evil-minded Duryodhana.**

सञ्जय उवाच ।

एवमुक्तो हृषीकेशो गुडाकेशेन भारत ।

सेनयोरुभयोर्मध्ये स्थापयित्वा रथोत्तमम् ॥ २४ ॥

भीष्मद्रोणप्रमुखतः सर्वेषां च महीक्षिताम् ।

उवाच पार्थ पश्यैतान्समवेतान्कुरूनिति ॥ २५ ॥

sañjaya uvāca | evam ukto hr̥ṣīkeśo guḍākeśena bhārata | senayor ubhayor
madhye sthāpayitvā rathottamam || 24 ||

Sanjaya said: Advised thus by Arjuna Lord Krishna placed the noble chariot in the middle of the two armies, and in front of Bhishma and Drona, and all the Kings, and said: ‘O Arjuna! Behold those Kauravas gathered here.’

VERSE 1.26

तत्रापश्यत्स्थितान् पार्थः पितृन्थ पितामहान् ।
आचार्यान्मातुलान्भ्रातृन्पुत्रान्पौत्रान्सखींस्तथा ।
श्वशुरान्सुहृदश्चैव सेनयोरुभयोरपि ॥ २६ ॥

tatrāpaśyat sthitān pārthaḥ
pitṛn atha pitāmahān |
ācāryān mātulān bhrātṛn
putrān pautrān sakhīṃs tathā |
śvaśurān suhṛdaś caiva
senayor ubhayor api || 26 ||

♦ tatra – there; apaśyat – saw; sthitān – standing; pārthaḥ – Arjuna; ♦ pitṛn – fathers/paternal uncles; atha – and; pitāmahān – grandfathers; ♦ ācāryān – teachers; mātulān – maternal uncles; bhrātṛn – brothers/cousins; putrān – sons; ♦ pautrān – grandsons; sakhīn – friends; tathā – as well as; ♦ śvaśurān – fathers-in-law; suhṛdaḥ – well-wishers; ca – and; eva – also; senayor ubhayor api – in both armies.

There Arjuna saw fathers, grand-fathers, teachers, uncles, brothers, sons, grandsons, companions, fathers-in-law, and friends in both the armies.

VERSE 1.27

तान्समीक्ष्य स कौन्तेयः सर्वान्बन्धूनवस्थितान् ।
कृपया परयाविष्टो विषीदन्निदमब्रवीत् ॥ २७ ॥

tān samīkṣya sa kaunteyaḥ
sarvān bandhūn avasthitān |
kṛpayā parayāviṣṭo
viṣīdann idam abravīt || 27 ||

◆ tān – them; samīkṣya – having seen; saḥ – he; kaunteyaḥ – the son of Kunti (Arjuna); ◆ sarvān – all; bandhūn – relatives; avasthitān – standing; ◆ kṛpayā – by pity/compassion; parayā – supreme/deep; āviṣṭaḥ – overwhelmed; ◆ viṣīdan – sorrowing; idam – this; abravīt – spoke.

Casting his eyes on all these kinsmen stationed on opposing sides, the son of Kunti was overcome with deep pity and sorrowfully spoke.

अर्जुन उवाच ।

दृष्ट्वेमं स्वजनं कृष्ण युयुत्सुं समुपस्थितम् ॥ २८ ॥

सीदन्ति मम गात्राणि मुखं च परिशुष्यति ।

वेपथुश्च शरीरे मे रोमहर्षश्च जायते ॥ २९ ॥

गाण्डीवं स्रंसते हस्तात्त्वक्चैव परिदह्यते । न च शक्नोम्यवस्थातुं भ्रमतीव च मे मनः ॥ ३०

॥

Arjuna said: O Krishna, at the sight of these my kinsmen, assembled here eager to give battle, my limbs fail and my mouth is parched. My body is shaken and my hair stands on end. The bow Gāndiva slips from my hand and my skin is on fire. I cannot hold myself steady; my mind seems to whirl. O Keśava, I see omens of evil.

VERSE 1.31

निमित्तानि च पश्यामि विपरीतानि केशव ।
न च श्रेयोऽनुपश्यामि हत्वा स्वजनमाहवे ॥ ३१ ॥

nimittāni ca paśyāmi
viparītāni keśava |
na ca śreyo'nupaśyāmi
hatvā svajanam āhave || 31 ||

◆ **nimittāni** — omens; **ca** — and; **paśyāmi** — I see; ◆ **viparītāni** — adverse;
keśava — O Krishna; ◆ **na** — not; **ca** — and; **śreyaḥ** — good/benefit;
anupaśyāmi — I foresee; ◆ **hatvā** — by killing; **svajanam** — own kinsmen;
āhave — in battle.

**O Krishna! I see many ill-omens and I do not understand
what good could come by killing my own people in battle.**

VERSE 1.32

न काङ्क्षे विजयं कृष्ण न च राज्यं सुखानि च ।
किं नो राज्येन गोविन्द किं भोगैर्जीवितेन वा ॥ ३२ ॥

na kāṅkṣe vijayaṁ kṛṣṇa
na ca rājyaṁ sukhāni ca |
kiṁ no rājyena govinda
kiṁ bhogair jīvitena vā || 32 ||

◆ **na**—not; **kāṅkṣe**—I desire; **vijayaṁ**—victory; **kṛṣṇa**—O Krishna; ◆ **na**—not; **ca**—and; **rājyaṁ**—kingdom; **sukhāni**—pleasures; **ca**—and; ◆ **kim**—what; **naḥ**—to us; **rājyena**—by kingdom; **govinda**—O Govinda; ◆ **kim**—what; **bhogaiḥ**—by enjoyments; **jīvitena**—by life; **vā**—or.

**O Krishna! I do not desire victory or kingdom or pleasures.
Of what avail are these kingdom, enjoyment, or even life
itself to us.**

येषामर्थे काङ्क्षितं नो राज्यं भोगाः सुखानि च ।
त इमेऽवस्थिता युद्धे प्राणांस्त्यक्त्वा धनानि च ॥ ३३ ॥

yeṣām arthe kāṅkṣitaṃ no
rājyaṃ bhogāḥ sukhāni ca |
ta ime'vasthitā yuddhe
prāṇāṃs tyaktvā dhanāni ca || 33 ||

◆ yeṣām—for whose; arthe—sake; kāṅkṣitaṃ—is desired; naḥ—by us; ◆
rājyaṃ—kingdom; bhogāḥ—enjoyments; sukhāni—pleasures; ca—and; ◆ te—
they; ime—these; avasthitāḥ—stand; yuddhe—in battle; ◆ prāṇān—lives;
tyaktvā—having given up; dhanāni—wealth; ca—and.

Those for whose sake we desire kingdom, enjoyments, and pleasures—teachers, fathers, sons, grandfathers, maternal uncles, fathers-in law, brothers-in-law, grandsons and other relations are all standing here ready for battle, having abandoned their wealth and very life even.

VERSE 1.35

एतान्न हन्तुमिच्छामि घ्नतोऽपि मधुसूदन ।
अपि त्रैलोक्यराज्यस्य हेतोः किं नु महीकृते ॥ ३५ ॥

etān na hantum icchāmi
ghnato'pi madhusūdana |
api trailokya-rājyasya
hetoh kim nu mahī-kṛte || 35 ||

◆ **etān** — these; **na** — not; **hantum** — to kill; **icchāmi** — I wish; ◆ **ghnataḥ** — being killed; **api** — even; **madhusūdana** — O Slayer of Madhu (Krishna); ◆ **api** — even; **trailokya** — of the three worlds; **rājyasya** — of the kingdom; ◆ **hetoh** — for the sake of; **kim nu** — what then; **mahī-kṛte** — for the sake of the earth.

These, O Madhusudana, I would not kill, though they should kill me, even for the sake of sovereignty over the three worlds - how much less for this earth!

VERSE 1.36

निहत्य धार्तराष्ट्रान्नः का प्रीतिः स्याज्जनार्दन ।
पापमेवाश्रयेदस्मान् हत्वैतानाततायिनः ॥ ३६ ॥

nihatya dhārtarāṣṭrān naḥ
kā prītiḥ syāj janārdana |
pāpam evāśrayed asmān
hatvaitān ātatāyinaḥ || 36 ||

◆ **nihatya** — by killing; **dhārtarāṣṭrān** — the sons of Dhritarashtra; **naḥ** — our;
◆ **kā** — what; **prītiḥ** — pleasure; **syāt** — will be; **janārdana** — O Krishna
(Maintainer of all); ◆ **pāpam** — sin; **eva** — only; **āśrayet** — would take hold;
asmān — us; ◆ **hatvā** — by killing; **etān** — these; **ātatāyinaḥ** — aggressors.

**O Janārdana, what joy can be ours in killing these sons of
Dhritarāshtra? Sin alone will possess us if we kill these
felons.**

VERSE 1.37

तस्मान्नाहं वयं हन्तुं धार्तराष्ट्रान्स्वबान्धवान् ।
स्वजनं हि कथं हत्वा सुखिनः स्याम माधव ॥ ३७ ॥

tasman nārḥā vayaṃ hantum
dhārtarāṣṭrān svabāndhavān |
svajanaṃ hi katham hatvā
sukhinaḥ syāma mādharma || 37 ||

◆ **tasmāt**—therefore; **na arhāḥ**—not right/justified; **vayam**—we; **hantum**—to kill; ◆ **dhārtarāṣṭrān**—the sons of Dhritarashtra; **sva-bāndhavān**—our own relatives; ◆ **svajanam**—kinsmen; **hi**—certainly; **katham**—how; **hatvā**—by killing; ◆ **sukhinaḥ**—happy; **syāma**—may we be; **mādhava**—O Krishna.

Therefore we ought not to kill our kinsmen, the sons of Dhritarāshtra; for, O Mādhava, how can we ever be happy by killing our own people?

यद्यप्येते न पश्यन्ति लोभोपहतचेतसः ।
कुलक्षयकृतं दोषं मित्रद्रोहे च पातकम् ॥ ३८ ॥

yady apy ete na paśyanti
lobhopahata-cetasah |
kula-kṣaya-kṛtaṁ doṣaṁ
mitra-drohe ca pātakam || 38 ||

◆ **yadi api**—even if; **ete**—these; **na paśyanti**—do not see; ◆ **lobha-upahata**—overpowered by greed; **cetasah**—their minds; ◆ **kula-kṣaya**—destruction of family; **kṛtaṁ**—caused by; **doṣaṁ**—evil; ◆ **mitra-drohe**—treachery to friends; **ca**—and; **pātakam**—sin.

**Though they, their understanding overcome by greed,
perceive no evil in the decay of families and no sin in
hostility to friends, why, O Janārdana, should not we, who
clearly perceive the evil in the decay of families, learn to
refrain from this sin?**

कुलक्षये प्रणश्यन्ति कुलधर्माः सनातनाः ।
धर्मे नष्टे कुलं कृत्स्नमधर्मोऽभिभवत्युत ॥ ४० ॥

kula-kṣaye praṇaśyanti
kula-dharmāḥ sanātanāḥ |
dharme naṣṭe kulam kṛtsnam
adharmo'bhibhavaty uta || 40 ||

◆ **kula-kṣaye**—in the destruction of a family; **praṇaśyanti**—perish; ◆ **kula-dharmāḥ**—family traditions; **sanātanāḥ**—eternal; ◆ **dharme**—dharma/duty; **naṣṭe**—being destroyed; **kulam**—family; **kṛtsnam**—the whole; ◆ **adharmāḥ**—impiety/lawlessness; **abhibhavati**—overcomes; **uta**—indeed.

With the decay of a family, perish its dharmas, which have existed from time out of mind. With the ending of the dharmas, adharma overwhelms the whole family. When adharma overwhelms the family, O Krishna, the women of the family become corrupt; and when, O Krishna, the women are corrupt, there arises a mixing of castes. This mixture leads into hell the family itself as well as those who destroy it; for their ancestors fall, deprived of the offerings of rice-balls and water.

दोषैरेतैः कुलघ्नानां वर्णसङ्करकारकै ।

उत्साद्यन्ते जातिधर्माः कुलधर्माश्च शाश्वताः ॥ ४३ ॥

doṣair etaiḥ kulaghnānām

varṇa-saṅkara-kāarakaiḥ |

utsādyante jāti-dharmāḥ

kula-dharmāś ca śāśvatāḥ || 43 ||

◆ **doṣaiḥ**—by the evils; **etaiḥ**—these; **kula-ghnānām**—of the family-destroyers;
◆ **varṇa-saṅkara**—intermingling of castes; **kāarakaiḥ**—causing; ◆ **utsādyante**—
are destroyed; **jāti-dharmāḥ**—traditions of the community; ◆ **kula-dharmāḥ**—
family traditions; **ca**—and; **śāśvatāḥ**—eternal.

By these evil deeds of the destroyers of families, which result in the mixing of castes, the eternal dharmas of caste and family are uprooted. We have heard it said, O Janārdana, that inevitably the men whose family dharmas are destroyed dwell in hell.

VERSE 1.45

अहो बत महत्पापं कर्तुं व्यवसिता वयम् ।
यद्राज्यसुखलोभेन हन्तुं स्वजनमुद्यताः ॥ ४५ ॥

aho bata mahat pāpaṃ
kartuṃ vyavasitā vayam |
yad rājya-sukha-lobhena
hantuṃ svajanam udyatāḥ || 45 ||

◆ **aho bata**—alas!; **mahat**—great; **pāpaṃ**—sin; ◆ **kartum**—to do; **vyavasitāḥ**—prepared; **vayam**—we; ◆ **yad**—that; **rājya-sukha**—pleasures of the kingdom; **lobhena**—by greed for; ◆ **hantum**—to kill; **svajanam**—our own kinsmen; **udyatāḥ**—set out.

Alas, we are resolved to commit a great sin, in that we are ready to slay our kinsmen to satisfy our greed for the pleasure of a kingdom!

VERSE 1.46

यदि मामप्रतीकारमशस्त्रं शस्त्रपाणयः ।
धार्तराष्ट्रा रणे हन्युस्तन्मे क्षेमतरं भवेत् ॥ ४६ ॥

yadi mām apratīkāram
śāstram śastra-pāṇayah |
dhārtarāṣṭrā raṇe hanyus
tan me kṣemataram bhavet || 46 ||

◆ yadi—if; mām—me; apratīkāram—unresisting; ◆ śāstram—unarmed;
śastra-pāṇayah—with weapons in hand; ◆ dhārtarāṣṭrāḥ—the sons of
Dhritarashtra; raṇe—in battle; hanyuḥ—should kill; ◆ tat—that; me—for me;
kṣema-taram—better/more beneficial; bhavet—would be.

**Far better would it be for me if the sons of Dhritarāshtra,
weapons in hand, should slay me in the battle, unarmed and
unresisting.**

VERSE 1.47

सञ्जय उवाच ।

एवमुक्त्वार्जुनः सङ्ख्ये रथोपस्थ उपाविशत् ।

विसृज्य सशरं चापं शोकसंविग्नमानसः ॥ ४७ ॥

sañjaya uvāca |

evam uktvārjunah saṅkhye

rathopastha upāviśat |

visṛjya sa-śaram cāpam

śoka-saṁvigna-mānasah || 47 ||

◆ **sañjayaḥ uvāca** — Sanjaya said; ◆ **evam** — thus; **uktvā** — having spoken; **arjunaḥ** — Arjuna; **saṅkhye** — on the battlefield; ◆ **ratha-upasthe** — on the seat of the chariot; **upāviśat** — sat down; ◆ **visṛjya** — casting aside; **sa-śaram** — along with arrows; **cāpam** — the bow; ◆ **śoka** — by grief; **saṁvigna** — overwhelmed; **mānasah** — mind.

Sanjaya said: Arjuna, having spoken thus on the battlefield, cast aside his bow and arrow and sank down on his chariot-seat, his mind overcome with grief.